

Whites on greens: On Wimbledon 2025

Wimbledon might be Djokovic's best chance for a 25th **Slam**

Tennis loves its traditions, and The Championships at Wimbledon more so. In the recent past though, the sport's most **prestigious Major** has **progressively** cut out many of its **famed anachronisms**. The **bespoke grass-court seeding formula**, the Middle Sunday holiday and best-of-five set doubles matches have all been **done away with**. Now, for the first time in the 148-year history of the tournament, there will be no **line judges**, and electronic calling will **take effect** on all courts. Yet, when the first ball is struck on Monday, there will be no **dearth** of the **verdant pomp** and **splendour**. If **anything**, a less **clustered** court, with its **glazed** green grass, **may lead to** a better visual experience, and give the best players, clothed in **pristine** white, a broader **canvas** to work their magic on. Chief among them will be Jannik Sinner and Carlos Alcaraz, the world's top two men who have now **established** an engaging **rivalry reminiscent of** the Roger Federer-Rafael Nadal duels. **Alcaraz**, in fact, **is** the two-time **defending champion** at SW19 and has won four of his last five tournaments, including the Queen's Club Championships. World No. 1 Sinner does not have similar grass **pedigree**, but his first-ever Slam semifinal was at the All England Club in 2023, and he won the only meeting with Alcaraz on grass, at Wimbledon 2022.

However, 24-time Major winner and seven-time Wimbledon champion Novak Djokovic is not to be **discounted**. The 38-year-old Serb is not in Slam-winning shape but grass presents the best chance. He finished **runner-up** in 2024 just weeks after a knee operation and the last time he exited Wimbledon before the final was in 2017. Among women, **No. 1 Aryna Sabalenka**, despite the bitter French Open final loss to Coco Gauff, **remains** the player to **beat** and there is no reason why her power-packed game cannot **triumph** in southwest London. But the last eight editions have seen eight different **victors**, **pointing to** an open field. For Gauff and five-time Major champion Iga Swiatek, Wimbledon has been the least rewarding Slam and they will be hoping to **crack the code**. American Gauff has not **gone past** the fourth round while Swiatek's best **showing** is quarterfinals. Defending champion Barbora Krejčíková, 2024 runner-up Jasmine Paolini and 2022 winner Elena Rybakina are among the other **notable** names. The Indian presence will again be limited to doubles with Rohan Bopanna, Yuki Bhambri, Sriram Balaji and Rithvik Bollipalli competing. As the country's tennis remains **stuck** in a **vicious cycle** of a shrinking talent pool, administrative **apathy** and **endless litigation**, it will be up to these players to **keep the flag flying**. [Practice Exercise]

- Red/blue coloring of words in the sentence indicates subject verb relationship; where 'red' denotes 'subject' and 'blue' denotes 'verb'.
- Go past (phrase) – to move beyond something.
- Showing (noun) – Performance.

Vocabulary

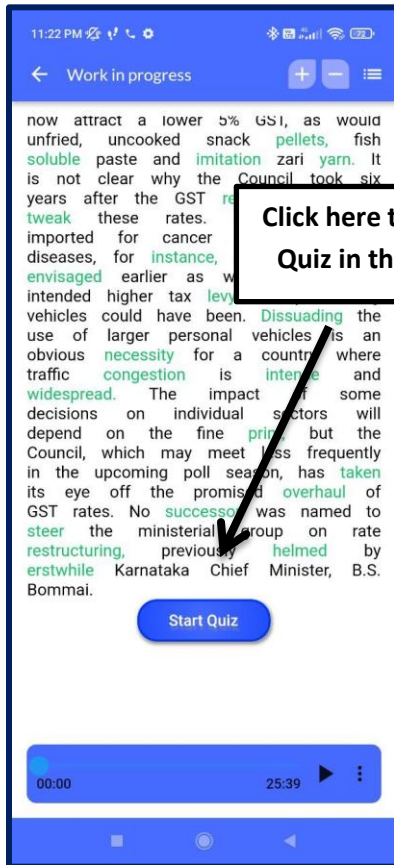
1. **Slam** (noun) a Grand Slam refers to winning all four major tournaments in a single calendar year प्रमुख टेनिस टूर्नामेंट
2. **Prestigious** (adjective) – Respected, esteemed, renowned, illustrious, celebrated प्रतिष्ठित
3. **Major** (noun) – one of the four most prestigious tournaments, collectively known as the Grand Slam प्रमुख प्रतियोगिता
4. **Progressively** (adverb) – Gradually, increasingly, steadily, step by step, cumulatively क्रमिक रूप से
5. **Famed** (adjective) – Famous, well-known, celebrated, renowned, legendary प्रसिद्ध
6. **Anachronism** (noun) – Relic, outdated practice, old-fashioned element, throwback, historical inconsistency समय से पीछे की चीज़
7. **Bespoke** (adjective) – Custom-made, tailored, personalized, specially designed, exclusive विशेष रूप से तैयार
8. **Grass-court seeding formula** (noun) – It is used to adjust the seedings of players based on their performance on grass courts, specifically over the past two years. This formula is applied in addition to the standard ATP rankings, giving preference to players with strong grass-court records
9. **Do away with** (phrase) – Abolish, eliminate, discard, remove, get rid of समाप्त करना
10. **Line judge** (noun) – an official who observes the tennis balls as they cross the boundary lines of the court.
11. **Take effect** (phrase) – Become active, start working, be implemented, come into force, go into operation लागू होना
12. **Dearth** (noun) – Lack, scarcity, shortage, insufficiency, paucity कमी
13. **Verdant** (adjective) – Green, lush, grassy, leafy, flourishing हरा-भरा
14. **Pomp** (noun) – Ceremony, grandeur, splendor, pageantry, display धूमधाम
15. **Splendour** (noun) – Magnificence, brilliance, glory, grandeur, majesty भव्यता
16. **Clustered** (adjective) – Crowded, packed, congested, clumped, grouped भीड़भाड़ वाला
17. **Glazed** (adjective) – Shiny, polished, smooth, glassy, glossy चमकदार
18. **Lead** (to) (verb) – Result in, cause, bring about, give rise to, produce वजह बनना
19. **Pristine** (adjective) – Spotless, pure, unspoiled, immaculate, clean बिलकुल साफ
20. **Canvas** (noun) – Stage, backdrop, setting, surface, field मंच/प्रदर्शन का स्थान

21. **Establish** (verb) – Create, build, set up, form, found स्थापित करना
22. **Rivalry** (noun) – Competition, contest, feud, clash, battle प्रतिद्वंद्विता
23. **Reminiscent** (of) (adjective) – Similar to, evocative of, suggestive of, recalling, redolent of याद दिलाने वाला
24. **Defending champion** (noun) – a player who has won the tournament in the previous year and is now competing again in the same tournament, aiming to retain their title खिताब धारक
25. **Pedigree** (noun) – Record, background, track record, experience, credentials अनुभव/योग्यता
26. **Discount** (verb) – Dismiss, overlook, underestimate, ignore, disregard नजरअंदाज करना
27. **Runner-up** (noun) – Second place, finalist, silver medalist, next best, near winner उपविजेता
28. **Beat** (verb) – Defeat, overcome, vanquish, triumph over, outplay हराना
29. **Triumph** (verb) – Win, succeed, prevail, conquer, achieve victory जीतना
30. **Victor** (noun) – Winner, champion, conqueror, first place, triumphant person विजेता
31. **Point to** (phrasal verb) – Indicate, suggest, show, reveal, demonstrate संकेत देना
32. **Crack the code** (phrase) – Figure out, solve the mystery, find the solution, decipher, succeed रहस्य सुलझाना
33. **Notable** (adjective) – Remarkable, noteworthy, significant, prominent, important उल्लेखनीय
34. **Stuck** (in) (adjective) – Trapped, caught, fixed, unable to move, mired फंसा हुआ
35. **Vicious cycle** (noun) – Endless loop, negative spiral, self-perpetuating problem, downward cycle, repeating difficulty दुष्चक्र
36. **Apathy** (noun) – Indifference, unconcern, disinterest, lack of interest, insensitivity उदासीनता
37. **Endless** (adjective) – Never-ending, perpetual, infinite, unending, ceaseless अंतहीन
38. **Litigation** (noun) – Legal action, lawsuit, court case, judicial proceedings, legal dispute मुकदमा
39. **Keep the flag flying** (phrase) – Maintain pride, uphold honor, keep reputation intact, represent well, continue success मान बनाए रखना

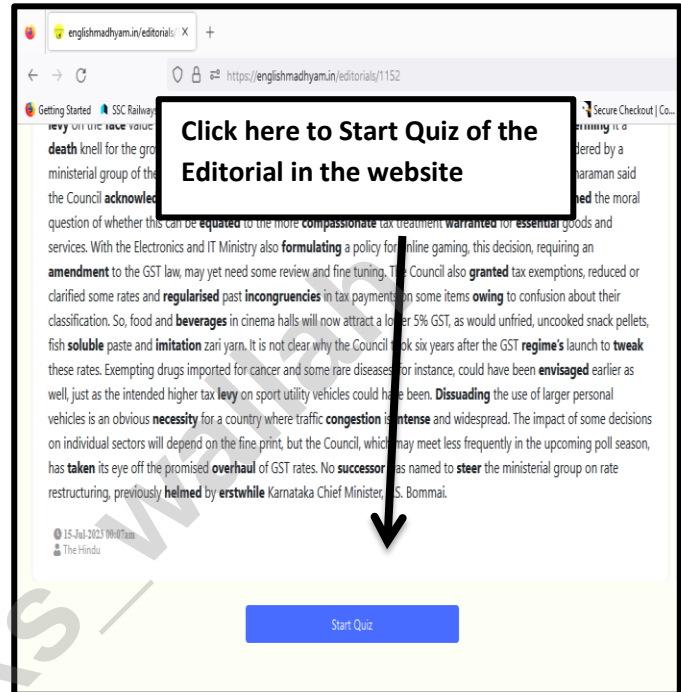
Summary of the Editorial

1. **Tradition vs. Change:** Wimbledon cherishes tradition but has modernized by dropping old practices like bespoke seeding, Middle Sunday break, and best-of-five doubles.
2. **Technological Shift:** For the first time in 148 years, Wimbledon will not have line judges; electronic line calling will be used on all courts.
3. **Visual Appeal:** The uncluttered courts with pristine green grass are expected to offer a better visual spectacle for audiences.
4. **Sinner-Alcaraz Rivalry:** Jannik Sinner (World No. 1) and Carlos Alcaraz (World No. 2) have forged an exciting rivalry likened to Federer-Nadal.
5. **Alcaraz's Momentum:** Alcaraz is the two-time defending Wimbledon champion and has won four of his last five tournaments.
6. **Sinner's Grass Record:** While Sinner lacks extensive success on grass, he reached his first Slam semifinal at Wimbledon 2023 and beat Alcaraz on grass in 2022.
7. **Djokovic's Prospects:** Novak Djokovic, despite recent injuries, is a strong contender given his grass-court pedigree and seven Wimbledon titles.
8. **Djokovic's Form:** He was runner-up in 2024 despite knee surgery; his last early Wimbledon exit was in 2017, proving his consistency.
9. **Women's Top Seed:** Aryna Sabalenka, World No. 1, is a favorite despite her French Open loss to Coco Gauff.
10. **Women's Open Field:** The last eight Wimbledon women's titles have been won by eight different players, highlighting unpredictability.
11. **Gauff's Challenge:** Coco Gauff has not advanced beyond the fourth round at Wimbledon and aims to break that barrier this year.
12. **Swiatek's Struggle:** Iga Swiatek, despite five Majors, has only reached the Wimbledon quarterfinals at best.
13. **Key Women Contenders:** Defending champion Barbora Krejčíková, 2024 finalist Jasmine Paolini, and 2022 champion Elena Rybakina add depth to the women's draw.
14. **Indian Participation:** India's presence at Wimbledon 2025 is confined to doubles, with Rohan Bopanna, Yuki Bhambri, Sriram Balaji, and Rithvik Bollipalli competing.
15. **State of Indian Tennis:** Indian tennis faces challenges of a dwindling talent pool, administrative neglect, and ongoing litigation, leaving doubles players to uphold the nation's hopes.

Practice Exercise: Banking Pattern Based



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